

Hassan Noor – Member 4

Assalam-o-Alaikum everyone.

My name is **Hassan Noor**, and I am the **fourth member** of this group.

I will now present the **case study, ethical analysis, and conclusion** of our topic on **bribery and gifts in the workplace**.

Let us begin with a **real-life ethical situation**.

In this case, a **contractor offers an expensive smartphone** to an engineer **before the contract decision is finalized**.

Because the engineer is in a **decision-making position**, this offer immediately creates an **ethical dilemma**.

At first, it may appear to be a simple gesture of appreciation.

However, the key question we must ask is:

Is this truly a gift, or is it a hidden form of bribery meant to influence the decision?

Ethical Analysis

When we analyze this situation ethically, several concerns become clear.

First, the **high monetary value** of the gift makes it inappropriate in a professional context.

Second, accepting such a gift can create a **sense of obligation**, even if the engineer tries to remain fair.

This can lead to **unconscious bias**, affecting objectivity and fairness in decision-making.

Most importantly, this situation **violates core engineering ethics**, including **integrity, honesty, and responsibility to the public**.

According to **Fleddermann's ethical principles**, any benefit that **influences professional judgment** cannot be considered an innocent gift.

Therefore, this is **not merely a social gesture** — it is a **serious ethical problem**.

Proper Ethical Response

So, what should a responsible engineer do?

An ethical response includes **three key actions**:

- **Politely refusing** the gift in a professional manner

- **Reporting the incident** to management or the ethics committee
- **Following organizational policies and professional codes of conduct**

These steps help protect **personal integrity, organizational reputation**, and most importantly, **public trust**.

Because in engineering, **doing what is right must always come before personal benefit**.

Preventive Measures

To avoid such situations in the future, organizations must implement **strong preventive systems**, such as:

- Clear and strict **ethics policies**
- **Transparency** in decision-making processes
- Effective **reporting and monitoring mechanisms**

Strong systems make **ethical behavior easier** and **corruption more difficult**, ensuring fairness for everyone.

Conclusion

To conclude, bribery and unethical gifts may seem **small or harmless**, but their consequences are **serious and long-lasting**.

They can **endanger public safety, destroy trust, and damage professional careers**.

Engineering is not only about **technical knowledge** — it is also about **moral responsibility**.

As **future engineers**, our **integrity** will define our success more than our skills.

So whenever we face such dilemmas, we must remember:

Ethics is not just a theory we study — it is a choice we make in real life.

Thank you.